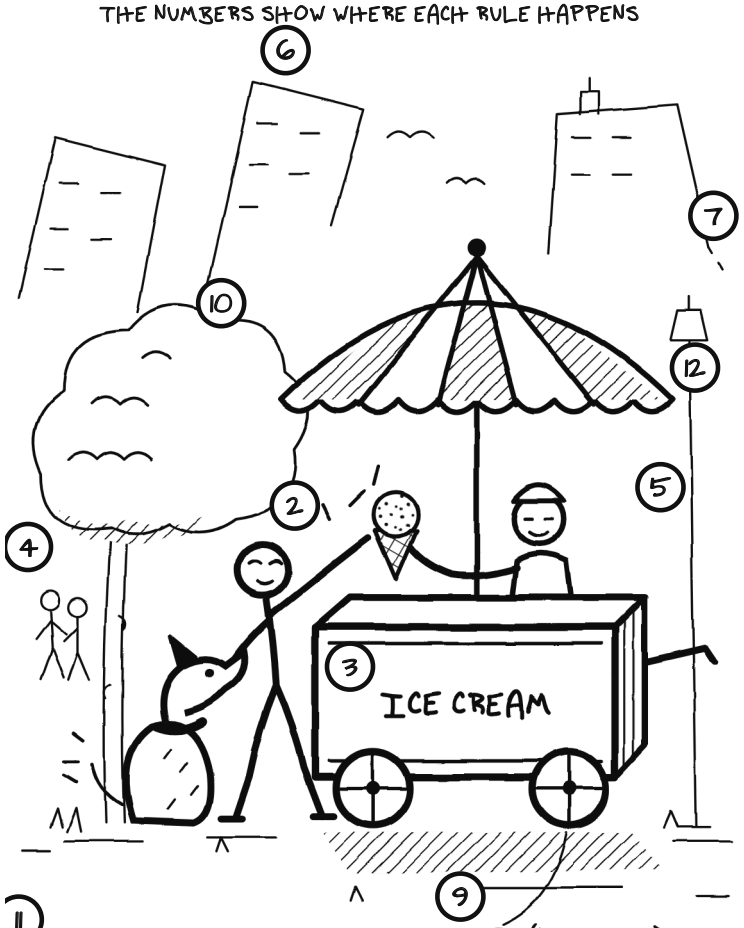
COO?

# DA RULES

12 RULES FOR DRAWING OUT IN THE WORLD!

OF URBAN SKETCHING

THE NUMBERS SHOW WHERE EACH RULE HAPPENS




### (1) SIT STILL LONG ENOUGH TO OBSERVE.

WATCH FOR 2 WHOLE MINUTES BEFORE YOUR FIRST LINE.

### (2) LOOK FOR A "STORY MOMENT."

WHAT'S HAPPENING? THAT'S YOUR SUBJECT.

### (3) START W/ LARGE SHAPES! NO DETAIL.

STORY MOMENT FIRST: **BIG**, IN THE MIDDLE. THEN BUILD OUT.

### (4) DRAW PEOPLE AS GESTURES, NOT PORTRAITS.

BEAN BODY, STICK LIMBS. SHOW WHAT THEY'RE **DOING**.

### (5) USE LINE WEIGHT TO FAKE DEPTH.

**CLOSE** = THICK + DARK.
**FAR** = THIN + LIGHT.

### (6) BREAK PERSPECTIVE RULES

(STRATEGICALLY!) LEAN IT OR BEND IT IF IT TELLS THE STORY.

### (7) LEAVE STUFF OUT.

NOT EVERY BRICK OR LEAF. LET THE EDGES FADE AWAY.

### (8) DON'T ERASE!

PEN FROM LINE ONE. NO PENCIL = NOTHING TO ERASE.

OOPS (KEPT IT)

### (9) TREAT MISTAKES LIKE THEY BELONG.

WRONG LINE? DRAW THE RIGHT ONE NEXT TO IT.

### (10) EMBRACE SPEED.

FAST LINES LOOK ALIVE. PEOPLE MOVE, SO **YOU** MOVE.

### (11) ADD NOTES OR TINY TEXT.

THE TIME, THE PLACE, WHAT YOU HEARD.

SAT · 10:42 AM
BAND PLAYING SOMEWHERE
SMELLS LIKE CHURROS

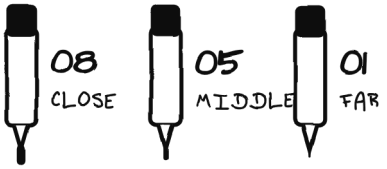
### (12) LIMITED COLOR POPS.

INK FIRST. THEN 2-3 COLORS, ONLY WHERE IT MATTERS.

**YOUR KIT:**



NO PENCIL!




**INK, WAIT, PAINT.** MICRONS ARE WATERPROOF ONCE THEY DRY. GIVE THE INK A MINUTE, THEN ADD YOUR COLOR POPS WITH WATERCOLOR.

## HOW TO BUILD A SKETCH FROM THE

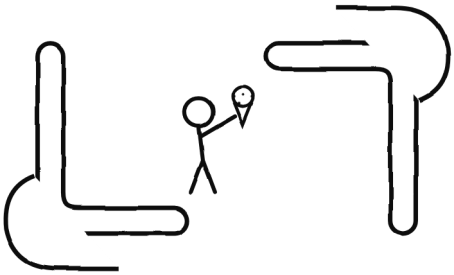
# CENTER OUT

DON'T DRAW THE WHOLE PARK! FIND THE **ONE THING THAT'S HAPPENING**, DRAW IT BIG IN THE MIDDLE OF YOUR PAGE, THEN LET THE WORLD GROW OUT AROUND IT.

### STORY MOMENT HUNT!

LOOK AROUND FOR ONE OF THESE... (OR FIND YOUR OWN)

- SOMEONE WAITING
- SOMEONE WORKING
- SOMEONE SELLING
- A DOG ON A MISSION
- SOMETHING BEING MADE
- ABOUT TO HAPPEN...
- TWO PEOPLE TALKING
- A KID + A SNACK

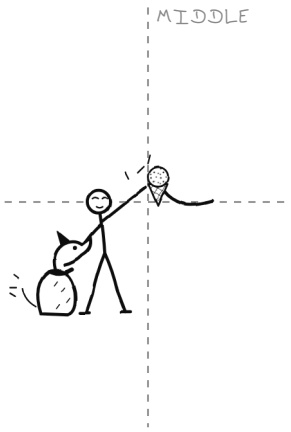


FRAME IT WITH YOUR FINGERS

**SIZE CHECK:** YOUR STORY MOMENT SHOULD BE ABOUT THE SIZE OF YOUR **FIST** ON THE PAGE. SMALLER THAN THAT? **START OVER BIGGER.**

### 1ST THE STORY MOMENT.

BIG, IN THE MIDDLE. THICK LINES.




### 2ND BIG SHAPES.

WHAT'S TOUCHING IT? ADD THAT NEXT.




### 3RD THE SETTING.

THIN LINES GOING OUT. EDGES FADE.




### 4TH POPS + NOTES.

2-3 COLORS, TINY TEXT, SIGN IT!




**NOTICE** HOW STEP 1 HAS NOTHING ELSE YET. THAT'S ON PURPOSE. GET THE MOMENT RIGHT AND THE REST IS EASY.

### YOUR TIME:

LOOK 3 MIN · INK 20 MIN
COLOR 10 MIN · NOTES 2 MIN

### KEEP SKETCHING!

FILL A PAGE A WEEK. TRY YOUR **LUNCH TABLE**, YOUR **STREET** FROM THE CURB, OR A **WAITING ROOM** (EVERYONE SITS STILL. FREE MODELS!). SAME RULES: FIND THE MOMENT, START BIG, BUILD OUT.